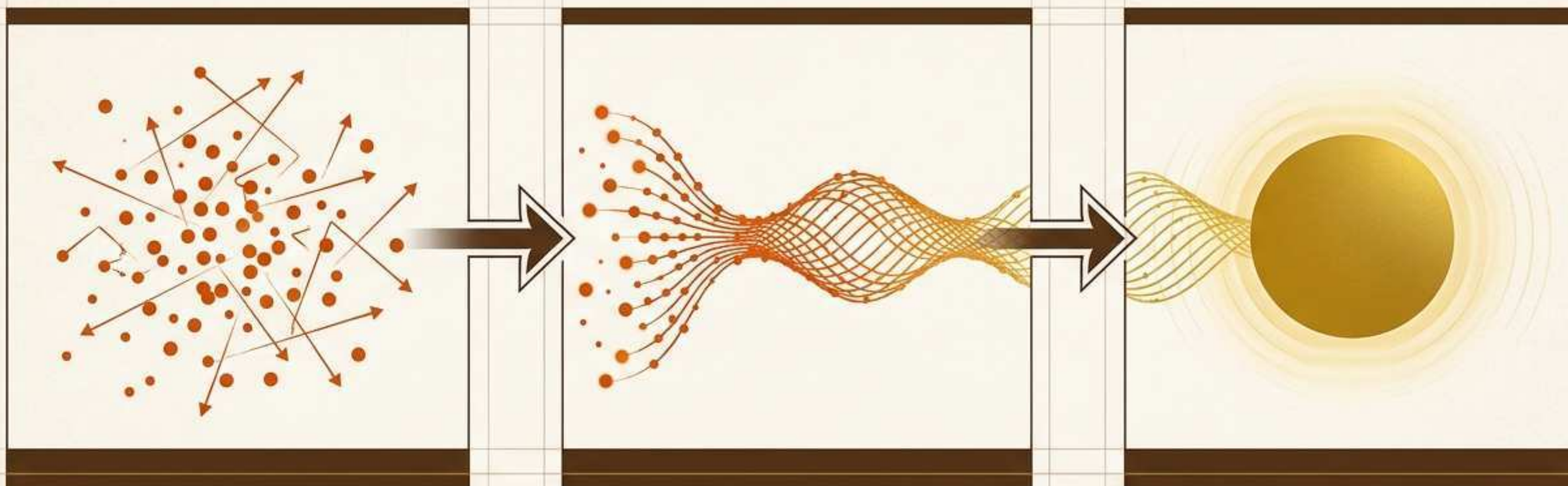


The Three Paths of Yoga

Routing patterned stimulation through the human architecture to transition from the manifest to the unmanifest.





Waking State

The manifest human experience, characterized by constant, scattered outward attention.

Patterned Stimulation

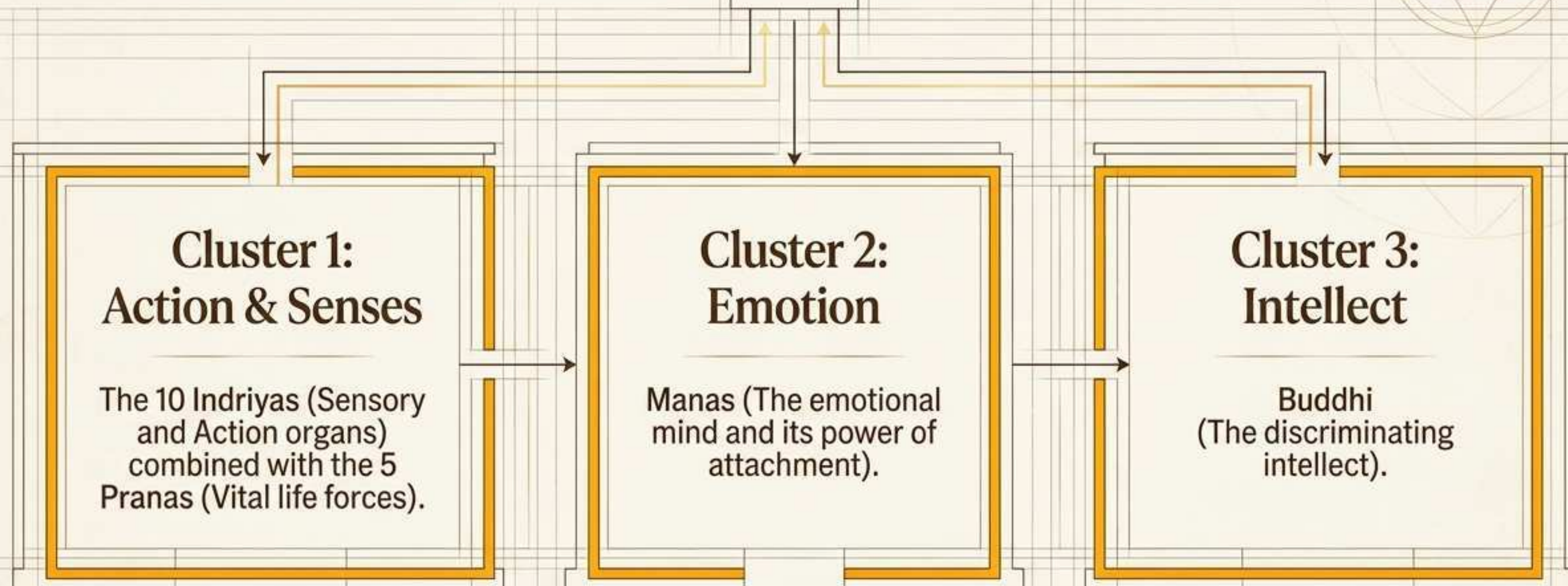
Yoga is not merely movement; it is the precise application of patterned stimulation to the human system.

Samadhi

The unmanifest state. The observer attains unlimited bliss.

The critical question of Vedantic science:
Where exactly in the human system should
this stimulation be applied?

The 17 Components of the Human System



The 'I' (Purusha) that observes these components never changes, even as the body and thoughts fluctuate constantly.

The Gateways Determine the Path

Gateway 1
(Buddhi)

Gateway 2
(Indriyas & Pranas)

Gateway 3
(Manas)

Directing
patterned stimulation into the
the intellect opens Jnana Yoga
(The Path of Intellect).

Directing patterned
stimulation into the sensory
organs and life force
opens Karma Yoga
(The Path of Action).

Directing
patterned stimulation
into the emotional mind
opens Bhakti Yoga
(The Path of Devotion).

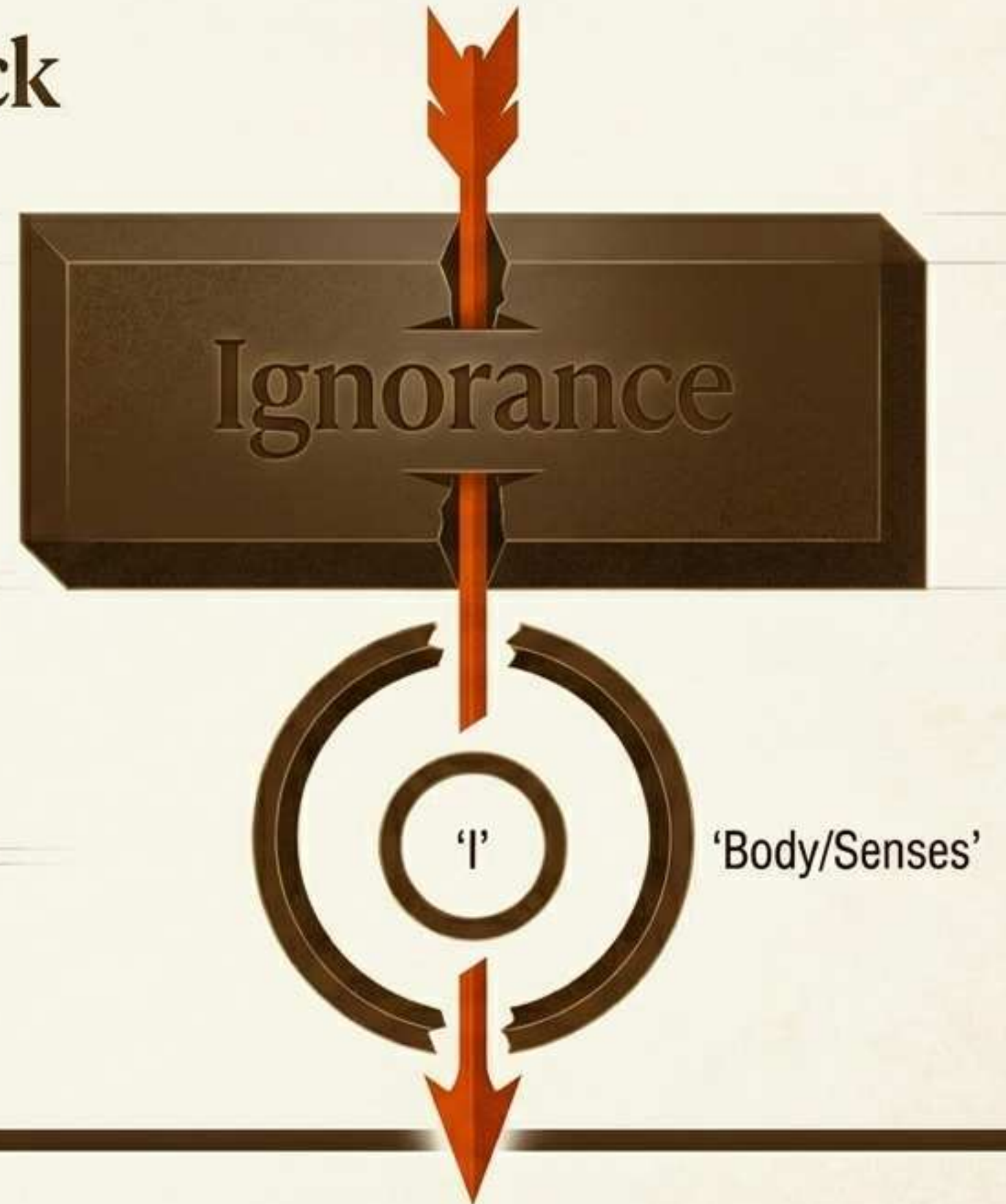
Jnana Yoga — The Direct Attack

Target Gateway: Buddhi (Intellect).

The Mechanism: Forcing the intellect to stop identifying 'I' with the body and senses. The body is analyzed purely as removable clothing. It is a direct assault on ignorance.

The Sacred Tool: *Tat tvam asi* (Thou art That).
The foundational mahavakya from the Chandogya Upanishad taught to Shvetaketu, proving the true identity is the supreme Brahman.

Suitability: Exceedingly difficult due to sensory rigidity. Reserved for the most highly disciplined practitioners (e.g., Rishis).



Karma Yoga — Crumbling the Fortress from Within

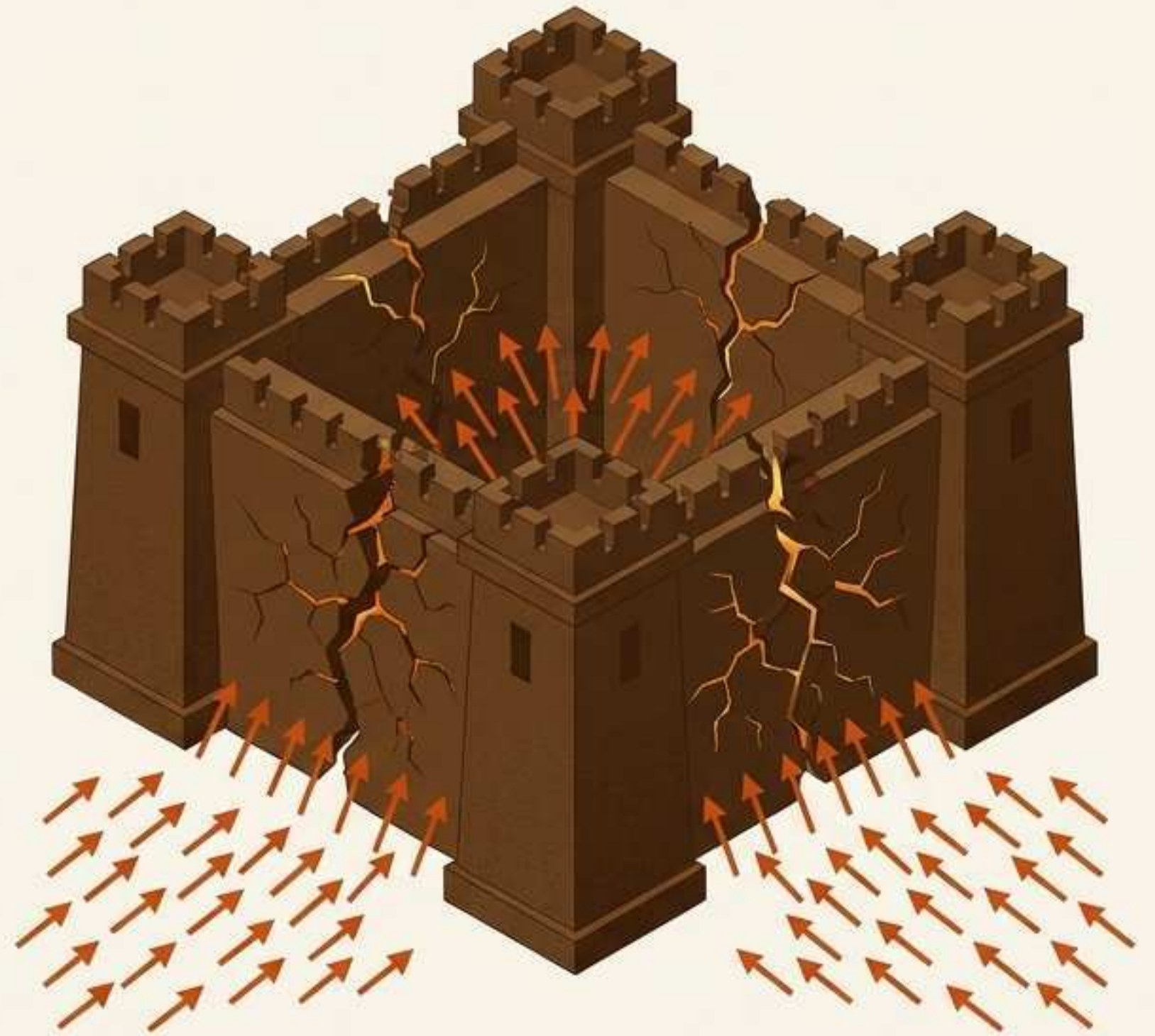
Target Gateway: Indriyas (Senses) & Pranas (Life Force).

The Mechanism: Instead of attacking the intellect, you feed the sensory organs specific, disciplined objects and rhythms to dismantle ignorance from the inside out.

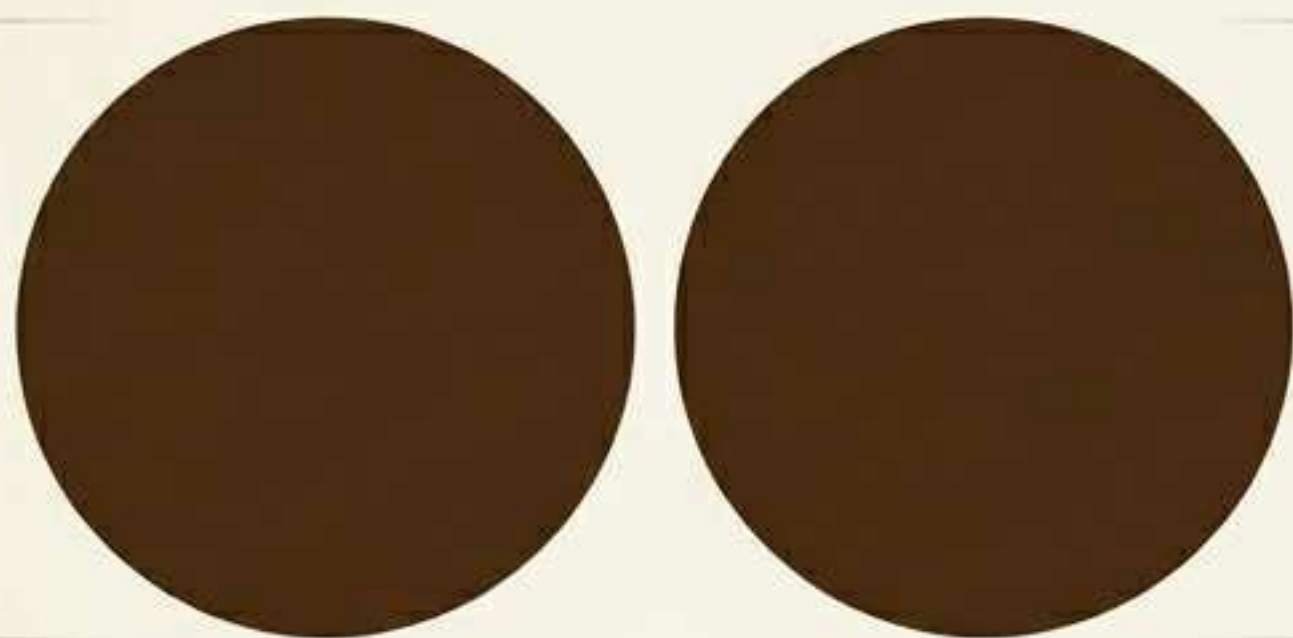
Applied Forms:

- **Eyes:** Deity meditation
- **Ears/Voice:** Sacred Mantras
- **Body:** Asanas (The foundation of Ashtanga and Hatha Yoga)
- **Prana:** Pranayama

The Higher Ideal: Performing action strictly for the high ideal of dharma, with zero expectation of the fruit (exemplified by King Janaka and Dharmavyadha).



Bhakti Yoga — The Technology of Merging



Vibhakta (Divided)

Target Gateway: *Manas* (Emotional Mind).

The Mechanism: Utilizing the natural power of intense attachment, but redirecting it away from personal desire and toward a Beloved. All actions become dedicated solely to the joy of the Beloved.



Bhakta (Merged / One who has become one)

The Beloved's Nature: Must possess *Atmaguna* (qualities of the *Turiya* state: compassion, forbearance, non-envy, purity, auspiciousness, generosity).

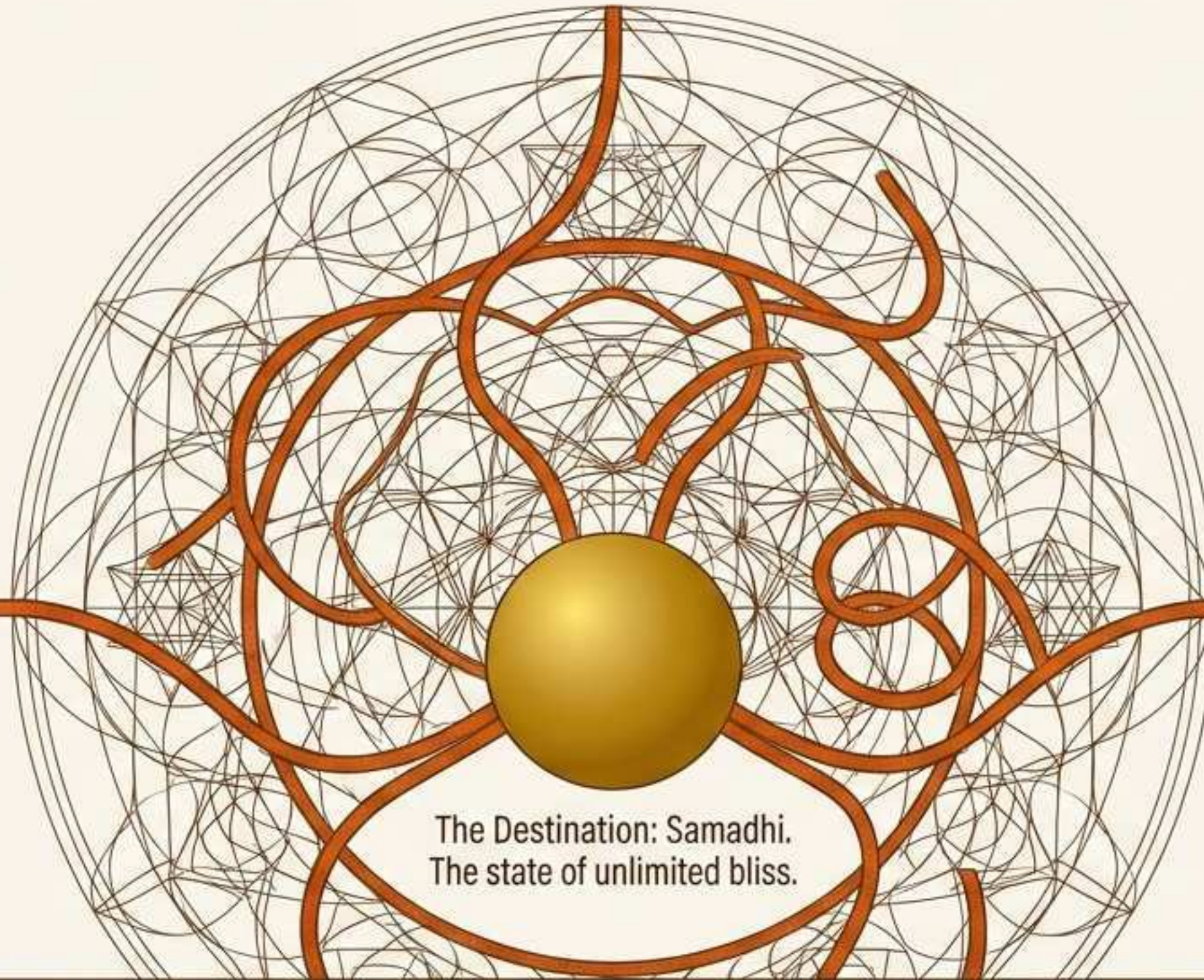
The Insight: Intellectuals may dismiss this as an emotional mistake, but it creates a supreme, higher-level restraint where the ego naturally vanishes into nectar-like love.

The Yogic Paths Diagnostic Matrix

Path	Target Gateway	Core Mechanism	Key Tools	Ideal Practitioner
Jnana Yoga	Buddhi (Intellect)	Direct realization "I ≠ body"	Mahavakyas (Tat tvam asi)	The highly disciplined
Karma Yoga	Indriyas & Pranas	Crumbling ignorance via action/rhythm	Asana, Mantra, Dharma	Those naturally driven to act
Bhakti Yoga	Manas (Emotion)	Merging ego into a Beloved	Intense love, Atmaguna	Accessible to all natures

Convergence

Three completely different gateways. Three entirely different sets of tools.
One ultimate destination.



150,000 Paths and the Role of the Guru

The Curiosity:

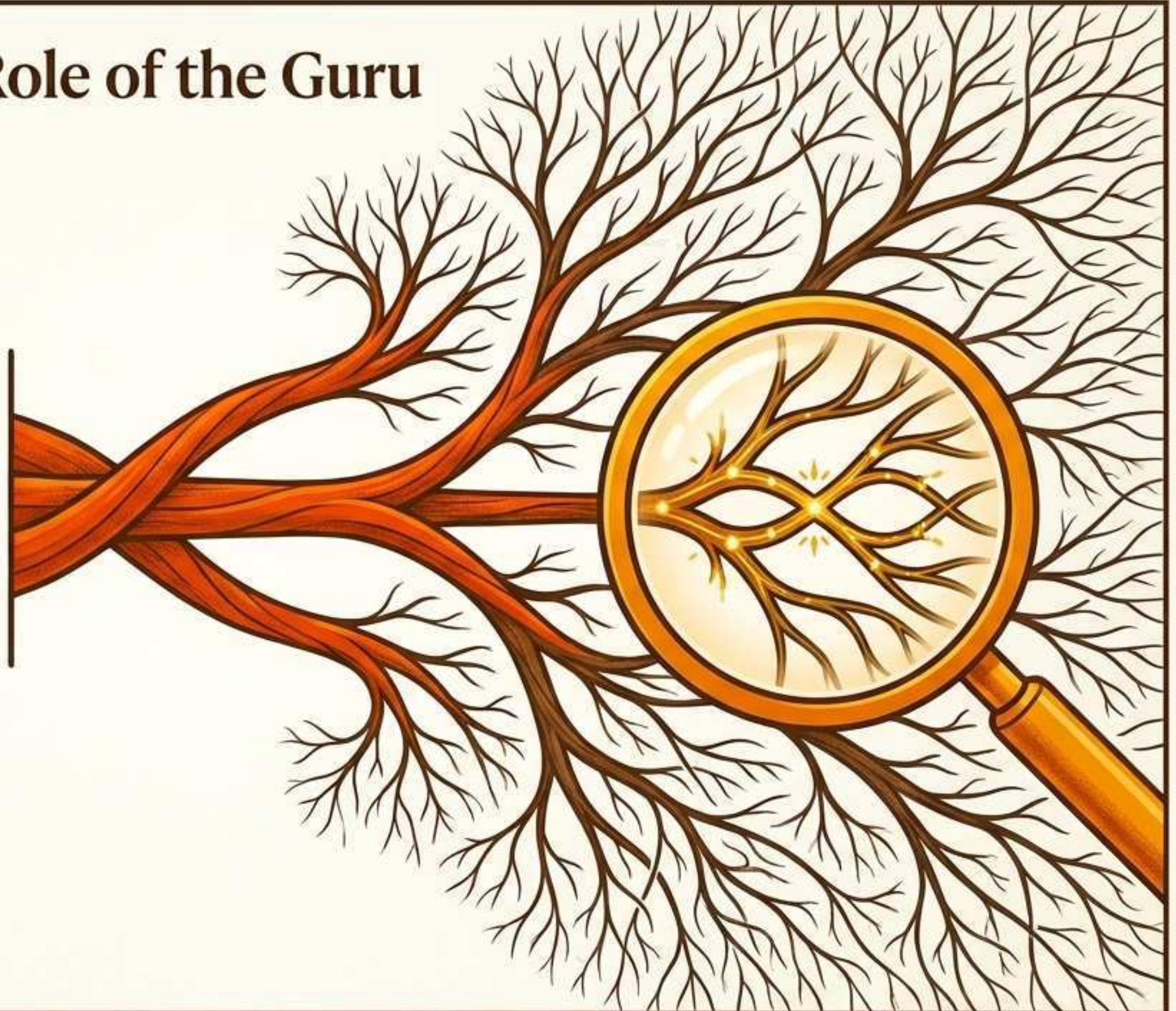
Ancient texts like the Yogataravali state there are over 150,000 disciplines of yoga in the world. How is this possible with only three gateways?

The Variable:

Prakriti (Individual human nature). Some minds demand intellectual rigor; others find it tedious and require physical action or deep devotion.

The Solution:

A true Guru analyzes the shishya's (student's) specific readiness and inherent nature, selecting the exact variation of patterned stimulation that will unlock their specific gateway.



Application & Experience

1

Find Your Gateway

What is your innate **Prakriti**? Do you naturally dissect and analyze (*Jnana*), build and do with your hands (*Karma*), or love wholly and intensely (*Bhakti*)?

2

Decode the Mantra

Consider the **Gayatri** Mantra. It contains a prayer for meditation (*dhimahi*) on light, and a prayer for intellectual inspiration (*dhi*). Ask yourself: Is this an instrument of Jnana Yoga, Karma Yoga, or both?

3

The Daily Experiment

Today, perform one small action purely for the task itself. Expect no personal benefit. Experience the total absence of “mine.” Observe what happens to your mind.